

NANDINI PILLAI

Product Designer who ships live AI products at scale - sole designer of LUCA, used by **16,000+ students**.

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Right to work in the UK, no sponsorship required now (Graduate visa, valid until Jan 2028)

EXPERIENCE

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| Baari (early-stage SaaS)
<i>Founding Product Designer</i> | United Kingdom
<i>Apr'26 - Present</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Founding designer of Baari, a business-first appointment-booking platform, owning both a React Native mobile app and a web dashboard end to end, from strategy to shipped UI, as one of two founders.- Defined the interaction patterns for the entire booking experience - from availability and scheduling to confirmations and reminders - across both mobile and dashboard.- Built the Baari design system in Figma and established the full brand and visual identity solo, giving a two-person team consistent, scalable UI across both surfaces.- Shaped Baari's positioning and roadmap through research with 5 pilot businesses, turning field findings into the product's priorities.- Shipped UI refinements directly in code with AI-assisted tooling (Claude Code), taking Baari from concept to a live pre-launch pilot. | |
| ISS Innovation Hub, Lancaster University
<i>Product Designer</i> | Lancaster, UK
<i>May'25 - Dec'25</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">- LUCA, a live AI careers platform used by 16,000+ students - sole designer, owning 19 features across 6 functional areas from definition to release under GDPR, no-AI-training, and bias-audit constraints.- Reduced a core daily flow by 3 steps by restructuring the information architecture after usability testing identified it as the primary point of failure.- Established and governed a design system in Figma spanning 80+ screens, keeping a live, actively-scaling product visually and behaviourally consistent.- Delivered 3 roadmap-level improvements from research with 40+ participants across 5+ co-design workshops, in partnership with engineering and product management. | |
| Imagination Lab, Lancaster University
<i>Freelance Design Consultant (client: Yifei Wang)</i> | Lancaster, UK
<i>Jan'25 - Apr'25</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Repositioned a UK early-stage startup's product, defining the positioning and MVP direction the founders took to market.- Conducted user and competitor research with 15+ participants to prioritise the MVP feature set.- Delivered a strategy and roadmap adopted by the client, shaping its positioning, investor narrative, and MVP plan. | |
| Smartivity Labs Pvt. Ltd.
<i>Product Designer</i> | India
<i>Oct'23 - Jul'24</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Designed an interactive STEM product end to end, prioritising hands-on discovery over step-by-step instruction so children stayed engaged for 2-3 hours per session, validated across 5+ usability studies.- Redesigned the product's core interaction flow around behavioural design principles, simplifying how users engaged with it, in collaboration with engineering. | |
| Imagimake Play Solutions Ltd.
<i>Design Intern</i> | India
<i>Dec'22 - May'23</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">- Cut support queries by 20% across 4+ product ranges by designing clearer instructional systems, from concept through prototype iteration. | |

EDUCATION

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| Lancaster University
<i>Master of Arts (MA) - Design Management</i> | United Kingdom
<i>2024 - 2025</i> |
| Symbiosis International University
<i>Bachelor of Design (B.Des) - Product Design</i> | India
<i>2019 - 2023</i> |

SKILLS

Core: Product Design, UX, Design Systems, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Mobile & Web (iOS & Android)

Research: User Research, Usability Testing, Co-design Facilitation, Competitor & Heuristic Evaluation

AI & Strategy: AI Product Design, Design-to-Code (Claude Code), Product Strategy, Go-to-Market, Cross-functional & Agile Delivery

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Miro, Adobe Creative Suite